

Identifying Dialectics

For each group, check the most dialectical response.

☐ **1A.** Pay attention to your effect on others.

☐ **1B.** Assume that others' reactions to you are unrelated to your treatment of them.

☐ **5A.** Examine a difficult relationship by looking at how the interactions over time between you and the other person may be problematic.

☐ **5B.** Assume that difficulties in a relationship are caused completely by you or by the other person.

Saying:

☐ **2A.** "I know I am right about this."

☐ **2B.** "I can see your point of view, even though I do not agree with it."

☐ **2C.** "The way you are thinking doesn't make any sense."

Saying:

☐ **6A.** "It is hopeless. I cannot do it."

☐ **6B.** "This is a breeze. I've got no problems."

☐ **6C.** "This is really hard for me, and I am going to keep trying."

Saying:

☐ **3A.** "Everyone always treats me unfairly."

☐ **3B.** "I believe the coach should reconsider his decision to cut me from the team."

☐ **3C.** "Coaches know best who to keep on teams and who to cut."

☐ **7A.** When you disagree with someone, be sure and be very clear about your point of view.

☐ **7B.** When you disagree with someone, try and see their point of view.

☐ **4A.** Judge friends as disloyal and uncaring if they start changing in ways you don't like.

☐ **4B.** Accept that interests change.

☐ **8A.** Demand that relationships be stable without changing.

☐ **8B.** Embrace change and see it as inevitable.

Note. Adapted in part from Miller, A. L., Rathus, J. H., & Linehan, M. M. (2007). *Dialectical behavior therapy with suicidal adolescents*. New York: Guilford Press. Copyright 2007 by The Guilford Press. Adapted by permission.

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